

Rulebook

Pitch Duel: Rulebook v0.3

Setup

- **Players:** 2
- **Board:** 7 spaces in a line: Goal A | A's Def | Mid | Mid | Mid | B's Def | Goal B
- **Ball:** starts on the centre Mid space
- **Equipment:** 1 six-sided die (faces 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, Powerup) and a 15-card Powerup deck
- **Hands:** each player starts with no cards and can hold up to 3

Goal of the game

First to **3 goals** wins.

Turn sequence

1. **Roll:** both players roll at the same time. Powerup counts as **0**, but the player who rolled it draws a card.
2. **Reveal:** both rolls are shown.
3. **Card window:** each player may play **one card** (the losing player decides first). Cards can be played after the roll, and some affect later turns.
4. **Resolve:**
 - Apply any roll modifiers (Rain, Red Card cap, Substitution, Injury Time). A roll can't go below 0.
 - The **higher roll wins** and moves the ball **1 space** toward the opponent's goal.
 - If the ball is already in the opponent's Def space, the win is a **goal**.
5. **After a goal:** the ball goes back to the centre Mid and play continues.

Ties

- **Tie:** reroll.
- **Both roll Powerup:** both draw a card, then reroll.

Cards

- You can hold **3 cards** at most. In the prototype, a card drawn into a full hand is discarded. On the physical board, you choose which card to discard.
- When the deck runs out, shuffle the discard pile into a new deck.
- You can play **only one card per roll**.
- A card whose condition isn't met has no effect and is still used up.

Card	Qty	Effect
Through Ball	2	If you win this roll, the ball moves 2 spaces
Counter Attack	2	If you lose this roll, the ball moves 1 space toward your attack direction instead
Offside	2	If you lose this roll, the opponent's move is cancelled
Goalkeeper Save	2	Blocks a goal against you, and the ball stays in your Def space
Red Card	1	The opponent's rolls are capped at 3 for the next 2 turns
Yellow Card	2	The opponent's next winning roll is cancelled (stays until used)
Substitution	2	Reroll your die once
Injury Time	1	Roll again and keep the higher result
Rain	1	Both players' rolls are reduced by 1 this turn

Ruling notes

- **Order of effects:** roll modifiers first, then compare, then Yellow Card, Offside and Counter Attack, then movement.
- **Through Ball:** if it carries the ball past the goal line, it's a goal unless a Goalkeeper Save is played.

- **Red Card:** it starts from the next turn, not the current one. Playing it again on a carded player resets the timer to 2 turns instead of stacking.
- **Counter Attack:** it counts as a normal move for the player who plays it, so it can score if the ball is already in the opponent's Def space.
- **Hidden hands:** you can see the number of cards your opponent holds, but not which cards.

Not in this version

- **VAR** (overtake a goal after it's scored) needs its own timing window, so it's parked for later.

Things to test

- Whether 7 spaces feels too long, since a goal now takes about 4 winning rolls
- Whether Red Card and Yellow Card are still worth holding
- Whether a Powerup roll (0 plus a card) is a fair trade
- Whether the 15-card deck needs more movement cards